CHAPTER 03 | 2012 TO THE PRE-2019 VENTURE YEARS

America on Borrowed Time

Academic ability meets financial pressure, loneliness, immigration uncertainty, relationships, and ambition.

Dramatic question Can Zino turn intelligence into independence before the pressures around him undermine his place in America?

Act I - Setup

America initially looks like the reward for years of struggle. Yet the familiar threat of unpaid fees follows Zino across the Atlantic: he nearly loses his university place. He studies social work and completes a master's in 2014 while adjusting to weather, food, loneliness, and relationships. His intelligence makes academic demands manageable, but cannot pay the bills. A proposed family-call scene can contrast the confidence he projects home with the difficulty he privately faces. His girlfriend becomes part of his support system, with her own perspective still to be developed.

Turning point: Arrival and academic progress have not delivered the security everyone hoped for.

Act II - Confrontation

Unavailable nursing documents obstruct an equivalency or licensing ambition, while immigration status creates a separate vulnerability. Depression and homesickness compete with the pressure to stay and succeed. Zino also writes music, giving private feelings a form beyond the confidence he performs for others. A nine-month Coursera blockchain course offers an unfamiliar route forward. Winning three hackathons in succession changes how he sees his abilities. The work provides a reason to imagine a future beyond his original professional plan, although the exact dates and nature of the competitions still need expansion.

Turning point: He begins to see something he might build for himself rather than another gate he must wait to enter.

Act III - Consequence

Confidence becomes a venture: Zino researches a cryptocurrency for Cameroon, develops Nkap, and then creates njangi.xyz. All of this precedes the 2019 deportation. Pitching to football friends brings traction and connects new ambition to familiar relationships. The possible future value excites him, while participation raises practical questions about contribution, ownership, access, and expectations. A proposed closing scene can place the energy of a successful pitch beside an unanswered question about how the venture will be controlled. The opportunity is growing faster than the security around its creator.

Turning point: His route toward independence now depends partly on the people he trusts with it.

CHAPTER 03 | DEVELOPMENT PAGE

Make this chapter yours

America on Borrowed Time

At the beginning	He arrives in 2012 carrying ambition, family sacrifice, and expectations of an easier future.
At the end	A master's, new technical confidence, and promising ventures expand his possibilities and his exposure.

Three possible short episodes

1. School Fees Again

An American payment deadline recalls the humiliation of being sent home from school in Cameroon.

2. Three Wins

The hackathon victories transform Zino's confidence and open a new definition of his future.

3. Football Friends

A pitch turns a familiar conversation toward Nkap, njangi.xyz, and their imagined future value.

Memory prompts

1. What happened at the university-fee deadline, who helped, and how was the threat resolved?

2. Which nursing documents were unavailable, which process required them, and what was your immigration timeline?

3. Date the course, each hackathon, Nkap, and njangi.xyz. What did you build, win, and present?

4. What did your girlfriend want for her own future, and which memory or song captures your life together?

Grand-Chukuchuku motif The hero's easy solutions contrast with Zino's private calculations, creative work, and dependence on others.

Details still open: Confirm exact award titles and residence in Oklahoma City versus attendance at East Central University. Keep professional licensing documents separate from immigration documents; future 'millions' are a hope, not a verified valuation.